

THE BARBARIAN

CLASS HANDBOOK



Unleash Your Inner Fury!

Are you ready to smash through doors, lift heavy boulders, and roar in the face of danger? The Barbarian is a fierce warrior who uses their anger to become an unstoppable force. You don't need fancy armor or complicated magic—just a giant weapon and a lot of courage!



CLASS MECHANICS

RAGE

This is your superpower! As a Bonus Action, you can enter a **Rage**. While raging, you are a combat monster:

- You get Advantage on Strength checks and Strength saving throws.
- You deal extra damage when you hit with a melee weapon.
- You have Resistance to bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing damage (you take HALF damage from most weapons!).

Note: You can't cast spells or concentrate on them while raging. You're too angry!

UNARMORED DEFENSE

Barbarians are so tough they don't even need to wear armor! If you aren't wearing armor, your Armor Class (AC) is **10 + your Dexterity modifier + your Constitution modifier**. Your muscles literally block swords!

RECKLESS ATTACK

When you really want to hit something, you can swing wildly! You can choose to have **Advantage** on your first attack on your turn. But be careful: if you do this, enemies also get Advantage to hit you until your next turn.

STRENGTHS

- **Super Tough:** You have the highest Hit Points (health) of any class in the game!
- **Massive Damage:** With giant weapons and Rage damage, you hit incredibly hard.
- **Simple to Play:** You don't have to memorize a giant list of spells. You just rage and smash!

WEAKNESSES

- **No Magic:** You can't cast spells to solve problems.
- **Ranged Combat:** You are best up close. If a monster is flying or far away, you might have a hard time reaching them.
- **Mind Tricks:** You might be weak to spells that target your Wisdom or Intelligence.

LEVELING UP (LEVELS 1-5)

As you go on adventures and defeat monsters, you earn Experience Points (XP). When you get enough XP, you level up! Here is what you get as you grow stronger:

LEVEL	NEW POWERS!
Level 1	Rage & Unarmored Defense: You start with your core powers! You can Rage 2 times per day.
Level 2	Reckless Attack & Danger Sense: You can attack wildly for Advantage! Plus, Danger Sense gives you Advantage on Dexterity saving throws against things you can see (like traps and spells).
Level 3	Primal Path: You choose your subclass! (See the next page). You also get 3 Rages per day.
Level 4	Ability Score Improvement: You get stronger! You can add +2 to one of your stats (like Strength or Constitution) or +1 to two different stats.
Level 5	Extra Attack & Fast Movement: You can attack TWICE every time you take the Attack action! You also move 10 feet faster. You are a speedy powerhouse!

SUBCLASSES (PRIMAL PATHS)

At Level 3, your Barbarian connects with a special kind of power called a Primal Path. Here are two fun, awesome choices:

PATH OF THE TOTEM WARRIOR

You connect with animal spirits who lend you their magical strength when you rage!

- **Bear Spirit:** While raging, you resist ALMOST ALL damage (except psychic). You are basically indestructible!
- **Eagle Spirit:** You become super fast! Enemies have a hard time hitting you when you run past them.
- **Wolf Spirit:** You help your friends! Your friends get Advantage when attacking enemies standing next to you.

Pick this if you love animals and want to be the toughest tank in the game!

PATH OF THE STORM HERALD

Your rage creates a magical storm around you! When you rage, you blast enemies with weather magic.

- **Desert Storm:** You blast fire all around you, burning enemies who get too close!
- **Sea Storm:** You shoot lightning bolts at your foes and can breathe underwater!
- **Tundra Storm:** You freeze the ground, giving your friends temporary hit points (like an icy shield)!

Pick this if you want to mix your smashing with some awesome elemental magic!

GEAR & STRATEGY

CHOOSING YOUR WEAPONS

Barbarians love big, heavy weapons that deal a lot of damage. Here are some great choices:

- **Greataxe or Greatsword:** These are huge two-handed weapons that deal massive damage. Perfect for a strong Barbarian!
- **Battleaxe and Shield:** If you want to be extra safe, you can hold a one-handed weapon and a shield to boost your Armor Class.
- **Javelins:** Always carry a few javelins! If a monster is flying or too far to hit with your axe, you can throw a javelin at them.

HOW TO FIGHT LIKE A BARBARIAN

Your job in battle is to protect your friends by being the biggest threat in the room!

1. **Rage Early:** Don't wait! Use your Bonus Action to Rage on your first turn so you start taking half damage right away.
2. **Charge the Boss:** Find the biggest, scariest monster and run right up to it. Keep it busy so it doesn't attack your wizard or bard friends.
3. **Use Reckless Attack Smartly:** If you really need to hit an enemy to finish them off, use Reckless Attack! Just remember they might hit you back harder.

ROLEPLAYING YOUR BARBARIAN

WHO ARE YOU?

Barbarians often come from tribes, clans, or wild places far away from big cities. Think about your backstory:

- Did you grow up in a frozen tundra, a hot desert, or a deep jungle?
- Why did you leave your home to go adventuring? Are you looking for a legendary weapon? Trying to prove you are the strongest?
- What makes you Rage? Do you hate bullies? Are you protecting a younger sibling? Or do you just really hate spiders?

HOW TO ACT

You don't have to be a grumpy grump all the time! Barbarians can be loud, cheerful, and fiercely loyal to their friends.

- **Be the Strong Friend:** Offer to carry all the heavy treasure, kick down locked doors, or arm-wrestle the local tavern champion.
- **Trust Your Instincts:** You might not read a lot of books, but you have great survival instincts. You can smell danger and track animals!
- **Protect the "Squishies":** Treat your magic-user friends like little siblings. If anyone messes with them, show them your axe!

"You can keep your magic spells and fancy armor. I have my axe, my friends, and a whole lot of anger!"

LEVELING UP (LEVELS 6-10)

Your adventures are getting more dangerous, but you are getting even stronger! Here is what happens as your Barbarian reaches level 10:

LEVEL	NEW POWERS!
Level 6	Path Feature: Your subclass gets a new power! For example, Bear Totem warriors become super strong and can lift incredibly heavy things. You also get 4 Rages per day!
Level 7	Feral Instinct: You are like a wild animal! You get Advantage on Initiative rolls, meaning you almost always get to go first in battle. Nobody can surprise you!
Level 8	Ability Score Improvement: Add +2 to one stat or +1 to two different stats to become even more powerful!
Level 9	Brutal Critical: When you score a critical hit (rolling a 20!), you get to roll an EXTRA damage die. Your giant hits are now MEGA hits!
Level 10	Path Feature: Another awesome subclass power! You also get 5 Rages per day. You can stay angry almost all day long!

FAMOUS HEROES & LEGENDS

Throughout history, many mighty Barbarians have become legends. Which of these heroes sounds most like you?

KROG THE MOUNTAIN-BREAKER

Krog was a giant of a man who loved his friends more than anything. Legend says that when a dragon trapped his party in a cave, Krog got so mad that he punched the mountain until it broke apart, creating a tunnel for them to escape!

SHEERA THE WOLF-RIDER

Sheera never walked if she could ride! She rode into battle on the back of a giant dire wolf. She was so fierce that even the monsters were scared of her loud, terrifying battle cry. She once arm-wrestled an ogre and won!

BEST MAGIC ITEMS

If you find a treasure chest, look for these awesome magic items! They are perfect for a Barbarian:

- **Belt of Dwarvenkind:** This magical wrestling belt gives you extra Constitution (more health!) and lets you grow a fabulous beard, even if you are not a dwarf!
- **Cloak of the Manta Ray:** A cool cape that lets you breathe underwater and swim super fast. Perfect for when you need to smash sea-monsters!
- **Flametongue Weapon:** A magical sword or axe that bursts into flames when you say a secret command word. It deals extra fire damage every time you hit!
- **Boots of Striding and Springing:** These boots make you jump incredibly far. You can leap right over the small monsters to attack the big boss!

COMBAT CHEAT SHEET

What should you do on your turn? Use this quick guide to remember your options!

ACTION

Choose one big thing to do:

- **Attack:** Swing your big weapon! (At level 5, you get to swing TWICE!)
- **Dash:** Run twice as far if you need to catch up to a fast enemy.
- **Shove or Grapple:** Push a monster over or grab them so they can't run away!

BONUS ACTION

Choose one quick thing to do (if you have one):

- **Rage!** Get angry! Do this on your very first turn so you take half damage and hit harder.
- **Two-Weapon Fighting:** If you hold a small weapon in each hand, you can attack with the second one.

REACTION

A quick move when it's NOT your turn:

- **Opportunity Attack:** If an enemy tries to run away from you without defending themselves, you get to smack them for free!

DRAW YOUR HERO!

What does your mighty Barbarian look like? Draw them here!

- What is their name?

- What is their favorite food?

- What do they yell when they Rage?

